

Killin Sports and Recreation Hub



Yellow Trail Description

This scenic route is good for both walkers and cyclists. It follows well-maintained forest roads, some smaller tracks which can be muddy in places. The fairly busy A85 has to be crossed twice when choosing this route and great care should be taken.

Leaving the war memorial car park head up the trail. At the crossing, follow **way marker 1** with the yellow arrow and turn right onto the old railway line and underneath an old railway bridge.

The Killin branch railway line was opened in 1885 and the trains brought tourists into Killin and down to the shore of Loch Tay – where they could hop onto a steam ship and get a tour of Loch Tay. The line was discontinued in 1965 and today the former railway-system is used as a hiking and cycling path.

The path will very gently incline for just over 2 km, leading through a mix of conifer- and mixed woodland. Have a good look around as this is a great spot to see red squirrels, jays and a variety of other birds, weasel and deer.

After about 1km you will pass Acharn Farm, a collection of old and new cottages with a tennis court to your right. Enjoy the view of one of their ponds with the hills in the backdrop.

Shortly after you will go over a rather inconspicuous bridge with some metal rails. Climbing down a short, muddy and steep path to the left after the bridge will lead you down to the burn and will reward you with an unusual sight: squeezed between the tunnel for the burn and the old railway line is another tunnel for pedestrians. During the time, when the railway was still active, this tunnel was used to move sheep and cattle from one field to the other without having to cross the rails.

Follow the old railway line until you come to a 4-way crossing with **way marker 2**, ignoring a newer forestry path turning off to the left earlier.

Go straight ahead and through a gate. Down on your right-hand side was the site of the Killin isolation hospital. Up until the middle of the 20th century, infectious people with diseases like Scarlett Fever were put into isolation

here. Another historical artifact which was demolished to its ground to make space for the conifer woodland industry.



Killin's "Fever Hospital" around 1950. Infectious people were accommodated here in the times before antibiotics. It was later turned into a holiday let before it got demolished to make space for commercial forestry planting.

The upcoming section can be muddy and therefore difficult, especially on a bike. Follow the small woodland trail for about 1 km. Very different in character, this is still part of the old Killin branch railway line. Take especially care after passing a forestry barrier. Shortly after you will have to cross the A85, a busy road, particularly during summer time. Best would be for cyclists to dismount and to keep children and dogs under very close control.

After carefully crossing the A85 you will see the old railway line continuing almost straight ahead (the train used to pass this road over a railway bridge). Look out for **way markers 17 & 18** here.

Potter along a land rover track and, for the first part, enjoy the open views to your right, seeing into Glen Dochart with its river Dochart winding its way through.

After roughly 1 km the conifer woodland will close you in again and after another about 500m – and after ignoring way marker 19 for now - you will reach the left-overs of what used to be the Killin Junction Railway Station. All that's left of it is part of the platform, rising above ground to the right. In former times, the trains coming from the main branch Callander-Oban would have stopped at Killin Junction, where you could change onto the Killin branch and vis versa. The main branch also closed in 1965. The cottage just below the platform is privately owned. It was re-built from what used to be the station master's cottage.



Killin Junction. Here, the two lines, the main line Callander-Oban (right) and the branch-off to Killin (left) joined together. Today, only some of the platform is left

Turn around to where you previously passed **way marker 19**, indicating to take the track going right. Follow it through conifer- and mixed woodlands, gently going uphill throughout. The track is the leftovers of the Callander to Oban main railway line and will bring you into Glen Ogle. You will pass a white cottage to your left, which used to be a station house. From 1870 until 1886, this station here was called “Killin Station”, before the line was expanded further towards the north-east (Oban). Thereafter it was renamed to “Glenoglehead Station”.



Train arriving at the former “Killin Station” / “Glenoglehead Station”. Today the former station house is used for housing.

Towards next way marker, you'll find the nice-looking Lochan Lairig Cheile to your right, where you can have a rest on its shore.

Once rested, carefully cross the A85 at **way marker 20** and turn left after (it is again advised for cyclists to dismount your bikes and to keep children and dogs under very close control). When reaching the small Glen Ogle parking, follow onto the path indicated by **way marker 21**.

Pass the memorial on the right, which was set up in memory for 2 members of the RAF who lost their lives here in 1994 when their Tornado ZG708 hit the hillside during a routine training flight.

Go through the gate and take the track to the right at **way marker 5**. Follow the rather dull forestry road steadily uphill for about 3.5 km and until you reach a T-Crossing. Turn left here (**way marker 6**) and get a nice little rest for your legs by going downhill for a short (approx. 500m) but steep section, hopefully being able to enjoy the views of the hills in the distance. At **waypoint 7**, the forestry road makes a sharp left turn. Stay on said road and ignore the smaller footpath going straight ahead. The ground levels out and becomes undulating until you reach **way marker 4** after about 1.7 km.

Turn right and start going downhill, steep in parts, so take care, especially if you are on a bike. Passt the barrier, keep left and leave the water work to your right (this is where Killin gets its drinking water from). Just as you see a small burn to your right you have the chance to visit yet another ruin: the former croft named Eilean Corr. It is located on the other side of the small burn and hidden behind a large, majestic willow tree. The small croft was occupied within living memory.

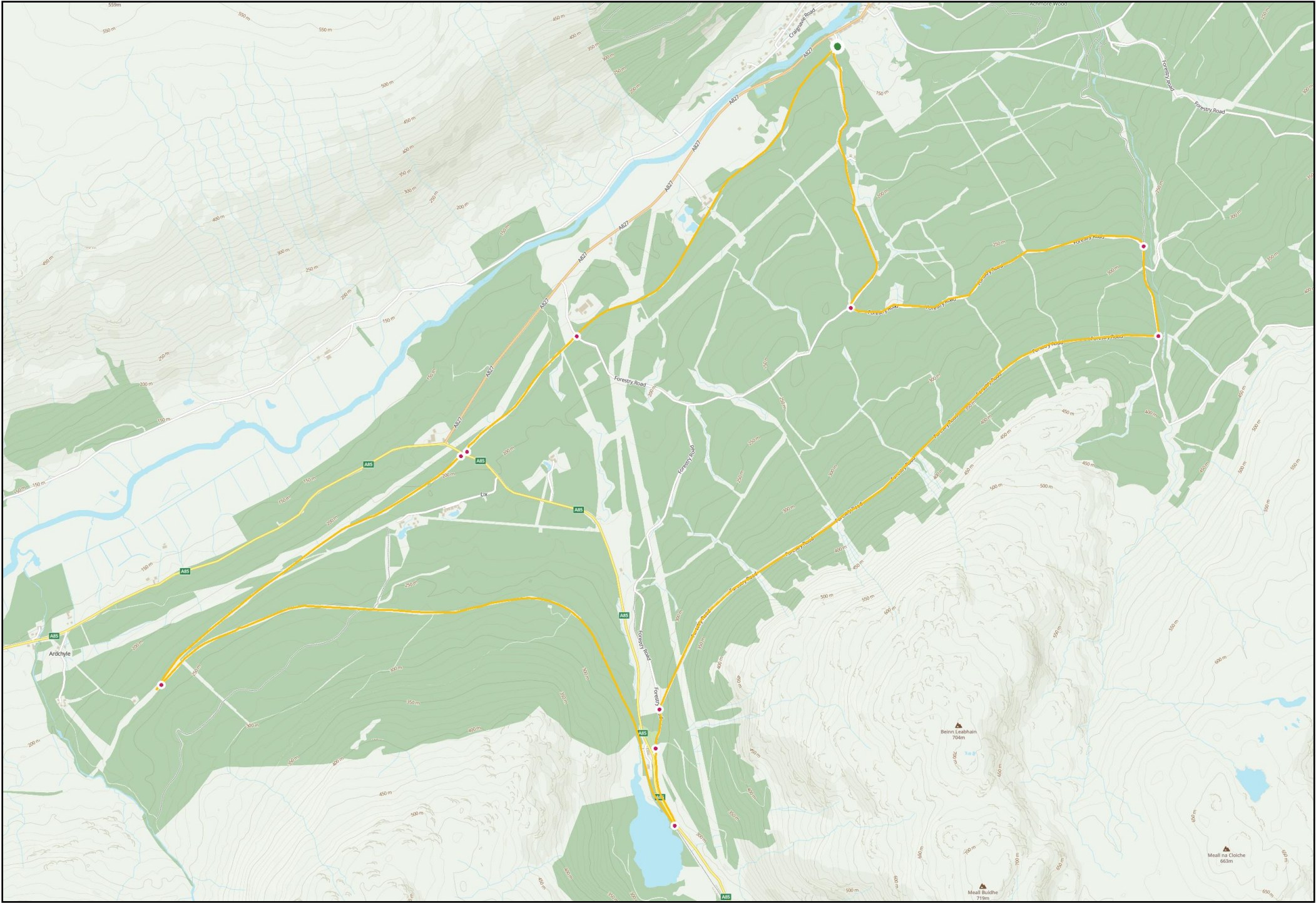


Eilean Corr with its last inhabitants around 1890

Follow the forestry road all the way down to your starting point and the car park – *and be please with yourself for conquering over 17 km!*

If you would like to support Killin Sports and Recreation Hub in maintaining and improving our trail network and other recreational facilities in the Killin area please scan the QR code or press control and click the link [Sports Hub donation](#)





ACHARN FOREST YELLOW TRAIL

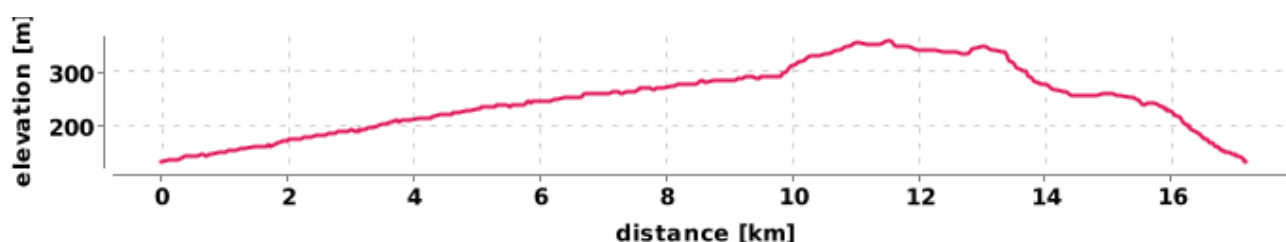
Route Information

Acharn forest Yellow trail

Route Summary

Total Distance **17.2 km (10.69 mi)**
 Elevation **133 m** at lowest point
359 m at highest point
 Total Ascent **275 m**

Elevation Profile



Route Card

#	OS Grid Ref	Dist from start	Latitude	Longitude	Elevation
1	NN 569 322 NN 5699 3221	0 km	56° 27' 37" N	4° 19' 20" W	133 m
	waypoint 1				
	start				
	Dist to next: 2.22 km , Ascent to next: 44 m				
2	NN 555 306 NN 5551 3066	2.22 km	56° 26' 45" N	4° 20' 44" W	178 m
	waypoint 2				
	Dist to next: 0.89 km , Ascent to next: 15 m				
3	NN 548 300 NN 5488 3005	3.1 km	56° 26' 24" N	4° 21' 19" W	192 m
	waypoint 17				

4	NN 548 300	3.16 km	56° 26' 24" N	4° 21' 21" W	193 m
	NN 5485 3003				

Dist to next: **2.17** km, Ascent to next: **45** m

5	NN 531 288	5.33 km	56° 25' 43" N	4° 22' 57" W	239 m
	NN 5316 2883				

Dist to next: **3.73** km, Ascent to next: **47** m

6	NN 559 279	9.07 km	56° 25' 18" N	4° 20' 12" W	285 m
	NN 5595 2796				

Dist to next: **0.47** km, Ascent to next: **7** m

7	NN 558 283	9.54 km	56° 25' 32" N	4° 20' 18" W	292 m
	NN 5586 2839				

Dist to next: **0.22** km, Ascent to next: **1** m

8	NN 558 286	9.76 km	56° 25' 39" N	4° 20' 17" W	293 m
	NN 5589 2860				

Dist to next: **3.6** km, Ascent to next: **47** m

9	NN 587 305	13.36 km	56° 26' 45" N	4° 17' 37" W	340 m
	NN 5870 3056				

Dist to next: **0.51** km, Ascent to next: **-56** m

10	NN 586 310	13.88 km	56° 27' 1" N	4° 17' 42" W	284 m
	NN 5863 3105				

waypoint 7
Dist to next: **1.77** km, Ascent to next: **-39** m

11	NN 570 307	15.64 km	56° 26' 50" N	4° 19' 16" W	245 m
	NN 5702 3077				

way point 4
Dist to next: **1.56** km, Ascent to next: **-111** m

12	NN 569 322	17.2 km	56° 27' 36" N	4° 19' 20" W	134 m
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